

with a central board of trustees and other concerned members. The EPF amount increases every year with the interest sum and deposited amount.

The amount you invest is eligible for deduction under the amount limit of Section 80C³³, which is ₹1.5 Lacs as of writing this revision.

Employees can take a loan against the amount accumulated in the fund. However availing of loans depends on permissible rules and circumstances and they can access money for reasons such as housing, marriage, children's education etc.

Checking the status of an EPF

The concerned department sends a statement of the EPF account to the contributing employees. The statement contains all the necessary information such as the opening balance, amount contributed in the current financial year, total interest amount earned in the current year, withdrawn amount from the fund (if applicable) etc.

Figure 3.1 shows what a typical EPF statement looks like:

Account Number		Name		The Employee's Provident Fund Scheme, 1952					
XXXXXX		XXXXXX		Rate of Interest : 8.5%					
				For the Year :					
Opening Balance ₹		Interest ₹		Contribution During the Year		Refund of withdrawal	Withdrawals during the year	Closing Balance ₹	
Employee's	Employer's	Employee's	Employer's	Employee's	Employer's			Employee's	Employer's
XX	XX	XX	XX	XX	XX	XX	XX	XX	XX
For REGIONAL PROVIDENT FUND COMMISSIONER, BANGALORE									

Fig 3.1 : EPF statement

Now a days, if your fund house is the central government controlled EPFO, then the entire process of passbook updation, balance check, transfers and withdrawal has been made available online, You are just required to login at EPFO website (<http://uanmembers.epfoservices.in/>) with your permanent EPF number and get instant access to your EPF passbook and all other features.